

VERIFICATION OF PAYEE (VoP) ROUTING AND VERIFICATION SOLUTION THAT ENSURES SECURE AND EFFICIENT PAYMENT PROCESSES BY MATCHING IBANs WITH PAYEE NAMES TO PREVENT FRAUD AND ERRORS.

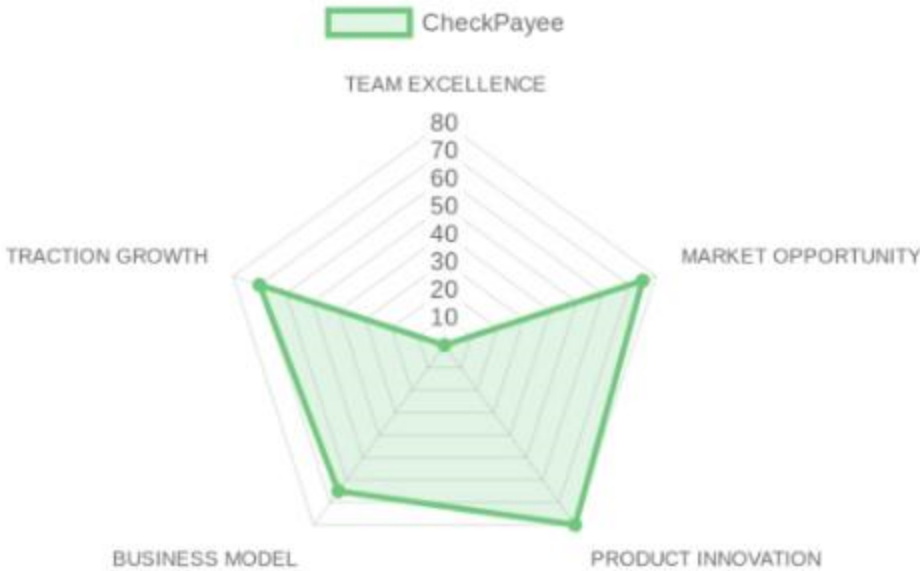
- RegTech & Compliance > SEPA Verification of Payee (VoP) Compliance Software
- B2B > SaaS

PRE-SCREENING SCORE
Thesis : Profund VC

NOTE: This is a raw pre-screening score. Thesis weights are applied in the Synthetic GP qualification pipeline after angle detection.

TEAM EXCELLENCE 0/100
MARKET OPPORTUNITY 75/100
PRODUCT INNOVATION 80/100
BUSINESS MODEL 65/100
TRACTION & GROWTH 70/100

PRE-SCREENING SCORE: 58/100 → POOR SIGNAL (<60)



In a NUTSHELL : CheckPayee is a SEPA Verification of Payee (VoP) Compliance Software that enables Commercial banks, payment service providers (PSPs), and fintech companies to secure and efficient payment processes by matching IBANs with payee names to prevent fraud and errors.

The PROBLEM : Financial institutions and payment service providers in the SEPA region face increasing regulatory pressure and significant fraud risks from authorized push payments (APP), leading to financial losses and erosion of customer trust if payee details are not accurately verified before transactions are completed.

The SOLUTION : Checkpayee provides a ready-to-integrate, fully automated account verification platform that performs real-time IBAN-to-name matching within the SEPA standard, leveraging smart matching logic and robust API integration to prevent fraud and ensure compliance with regulatory mandates.

The GTM : CheckPayee primarily targets commercial banks, payment service providers, and fintech companies in the DACH region through a direct enterprise sales motion, capitalizing on the October 2025 EU Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) VoP mandate as a clear catalyst for adoption among institutions seeking regulatory compliance and enhanced fraud prevention.

TEAM EXCELLENCE (NA%) | Score: 0/100

- Founder-Market Fit (25%) | Score: 0/100: Due to a complete absence of data regarding the CEO's professional narrative and academic background, there is no basis to assess Founder-Market Fit for Justin Clapham.
- Track Record (25%) | Score: 0/100: Without any work history, previous achievements, or investor information for the CEO, a track record cannot be evaluated.
- Leadership (25%) | Score: 0/100: The absence of detailed information on past roles makes it impossible to assess the CEO's leadership capabilities or broader team-building efforts.
- Completeness (25%) | Score: 0/100: With no available work history or self-summary, a comprehensive assessment of the CEO's profile and its complementary components within the team is impossible.

MARKET OPPORTUNITY (NA%) | Score: 75/100

- Size & Growth (25%) | Score: 75/100: The market for Verification of Payee (VoP) solutions within the SEPA region is substantial and growth-oriented, driven by the increasing volume of instant payments and the growing threat of APP fraud, impacting commercial banks and PSPs.
- Timing Why Now (25%) | Score: 100/100: The October 2025 EU Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) and the broader PSD2/PSD3 mandates create an immediate and non-negotiable demand for VoP solutions, making this a critical 'why now' moment for compliance-driven adoption.
- Competition (25%) | Score: 70/100: While specific competitors are emerging, CheckPayee operates in a market where widespread VoP adoption is nascent, offering a window to establish leadership, though larger payment infrastructure providers are likely expanding their offerings.
- Expansion (25%) | Score: 50/100: The immediate focus is SEPA compliance, offering clear expansion opportunities within the EU Instant Payments market and potentially evolving into broader payment security or RegTech services, though specific international strategies beyond SEPA are not detailed.

PRODUCT INNOVATION (NA%) | Score: 80/100

- Differentiation (25%) | Score: 85/100: CheckPayee's core strength lies in its ready-to-integrate, automated IBAN-to-name matching solution, which includes support for alternative identifiers and smart matching logic (Levenshtein- and phonetics-based), offering a precise and efficient fraud prevention mechanism for SEPA payments.
- Product-Market Fit (25%) | Score: 80/100: Serving '50+ financial institutions' and explicitly mentioning major banks like Deutsche Bank and Commerzbank demonstrates strong product-market fit, particularly for institutions needing to comply with the impending EU VoP mandate.
- Scalability (25%) | Score: 75/100: The platform supports batch processing for 250,000+ requests, <1 second average response times, and offers both cloud-native and on-premise deployment options, indicating robust technical scalability for high-volume financial transactions.
- IP & Barriers (25%) | Score: 70/100: CheckPayee's ISO 27001 certification, GDPR compliance, and end-to-end encryption establish strong security and regulatory barriers to entry, further enhanced by its direct integration with financial institutions via standardized APIs.

BUSINESS MODEL (NA%) | Score: 65/100

- Unit Economics (25%) | Score: 50/100: Public pricing information is not available, which makes it impossible to fully assess the unit economics or pricing strategy, though it is likely a tiered, volume-based model for enterprise clients.
- Revenue Model (25%) | Score: 70/100: The model is B2B, likely Enterprise SaaS or license-based, targeting financial institutions for regulatory compliance and fraud prevention, suggesting predictable, recurring revenue streams based on transaction volume or institutional size.
- Monetization (25%) | Score: 70/100: While specific tiers are not public, the value proposition for compliance, fraud prevention, and operational efficiency suggests strong potential for monetizing through API access, real-time validation, and batch processing, with upsell opportunities for advanced features or higher volumes.
- Capital Efficiency (25%) | Score: 70/100: Without any disclosed funding rounds, the company's growth to '50+ financial institutions' and a network of 250+ developers implies a focus on capital efficiency, suggesting organic growth or minimal external funding to date, though specific burn rates are unknown.

TRACTION & GROWTH (NA%) | Score: 70/100

- Revenue Growth (25%) | Score: 60/100: No specific revenue growth figures are provided, but serving '50+ financial institutions' since being founded in 2011, with expertise related to major banks since 2016, indicates steady if undisclosed customer growth.
- Customer Validation (25%) | Score: 80/100: The company boasts '50+ financial institutions' as clients, including mentions of expertise related to Deutsche Bank, Sparkassen, and Commerzbank, providing strong validation of their solution's effectiveness and market acceptance.
- KPI Progression (25%) | Score: 70/100: The company's mention of a 'network of 250+ developers' and active job postings for diverse roles (developers, sales, customer support) indicates ongoing expansion and a commitment to scaling its team and capabilities to meet growing demand.
- Market Penetration (25%) | Score: 70/100: CheckPayee's focus on the SEPA region and the DACH market suggests a concentrated geographic penetration strategy, effectively serving a key segment affected by the EU VoP mandate with a growing client base among financial institutions.

RISK TO UNDERWRITE :

The primary risk is the complete lack of verifiable founder information, which makes it impossible to assess the executive team's capability, leadership, and resilience, a fundamental component of early-stage venture investment. This bet on an unknown leadership profile could prove fatal if the CEO lacks the necessary DNA to navigate market shifts or scale the organization, with early signs visible in operational friction or hiring challenges. This risk is only resolvable through rigorous direct diligence and extensive reference checks, as public data offers no basis for assessment.

CHECKPAYEE'S EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (2)

 **KEY COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGES :**

- **Regulatory Compliance Focus:** CheckPayee's direct alignment with the October 2025 EU Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) and experience with PSD2/PSD3 positions it as a go-to solution for financial institutions facing mandatory Verification of Payee checks, easing their compliance burden.
- **Ready-to-Integrate & Automated System:** The fully automated, API-driven account verification platform with <1 second response times drastically reduces integration overhead and operational costs for banks and PSPs, providing immediate fraud prevention and efficiency gains.
- **Smart Matching Logic:** The use of Levenshtein- and phonetics-based smart matching, coupled with support for alternative identifiers, ensures a highly accurate IBAN-to-name verification process, minimizing false positives and enhancing fraud detection far beyond simple string matching.
- **Established Client Footprint:** Already serving '50+ financial institutions' including major German banks, CheckPayee demonstrates proven real-world effectiveness and institutional trust, providing a strong validation signal for new prospective clients within the regulated financial sector.

 **MOAT : MODERATE**

The primary moat mechanism for CheckPayee stems from regulatory lock-in and deep integration into critical financial infrastructure; as more financial institutions adopt their VoP solution to comply with mandates and prevent fraud, the company embeds itself deeper into the payment rails, increasing switching costs and data value over time. This moat strengthens as the platform processes more transactions, feeding an AI/ML-driven fraud detection system that becomes increasingly accurate and valuable with scale, creating a compounding feedback loop where more usage improves the product and further entrenches its position. A secondary layer of defensibility comes from ISO 27001 certification and GDPR compliance, which are non-trivial barriers for new entrants, combined with the domain-specific expertise required to navigate complex SEPA standards.

 **ASYMMETRIC WAGER**

- **The Bull Case:**
CheckPayee becomes the default, ubiquitous Verification of Payee (VoP) infrastructure layer for instant payments across the entire SEPA region by successfully converting the immediate regulatory compliance imperative into long-term fraud prevention and operational efficiency stickiness, crossing the inflection point where its platform becomes an indispensable, high-volume utility forming the backbone of secure interbank payments.
- **The Bear Case :**
CheckPayee's strategy hinges on the assumption that financial institutions will prefer a dedicated, best-of-breed VoP solution from a specialist rather than relying on bundled offerings from larger payment infrastructure providers or incumbent processing networks, a bet that could be quickly rendered moot if major players integrate competitive VoP features natively or offer them as loss leaders, becoming visible as early as late 2024 through competitive product announcements or major customer wins by diversified incumbents.

 **RED FLAGS**

- **Universal Risks:** The complete lack of transparent information regarding the CEO's professional background and founder DNA presents a significant universal risk, as investor confidence in early-stage companies is heavily reliant on the quality and track record of its leadership.
- **Thesis-Specific Mismatches:** The absence of disclosed funding rounds and a publicly available CEO profile conflicts directly with Profund VC's thesis of identifying and backing founders with clear 'earned secrets' and robust execution histories, making comprehensive due diligence impossible at this stage.

 **FIRST MEETING PREP KIT**

Given the compelling market opportunity driven by the EU VoP mandate, but the critical information vacuum surrounding the CEO and funding, our first conversation must immediately address the foundation of trust and capability.

- **The Investment Angle:** We are making a core wager on CheckPayee's ability to capitalize on a deeply enforced regulatory tailwind to become the indispensable VoP platform for European financial institutions, contingent on discovering a compelling and high-performing leadership team behind the current opaque facade to execute this expansion.
- **Killer Questions for First Call :**

- **GTM MECHANICS :**
Beyond the current client base, what is your most capital-efficient customer acquisition channel for penetrating new geographies within the SEPA region post-mandate, and how does your sales cycle for these new clients compare to your historic ~2- to 4-week 'go-live' promise?

- **THE CORE ASSUMPTION :**
Considering the rise of bundled payment solutions from large incumbents, what concrete evidence beyond your current client list can you provide that financial institutions will continue to prefer a standalone, specialist VoP provider for their compliance and fraud prevention needs, and at what price point is that preference sustainable from our unit economics perspective?

- **UNIT ECONOMICS STRESS TEST :**
For your typical enterprise deployment, what is the annual recurring revenue (ARR) per client, what is the blended fully-loaded customer acquisition cost (CAC), and what are the three most significant levers you are actively pulling to improve that LTV:CAC ratio?

- **First Meeting Go/No-Go Signal :**
Receiving a clear, detailed, and verifiable professional history for the CEO, including past roles and achievements, would be the immediate green light to proceed to deeper diligence; conversely, if the founder is unable or unwilling to provide this fundamental transparency, it would be an immediate pass.

 **DATA CONFIDENCE : LOW**

- The data is thinnest on the founder's background and the company's financial metrics (funding, specific revenue, exact unit economics), which must be the central focus of any diligence. The market timing and product capabilities are clearer, but the unknown execution capacity of the team is the most material gap.
- **DATA GAPS :** CEO's full career timeline - Academic background - Founder DNA assessment - Public funding rounds - Revenue figures - Pricing tiers - Customer churn metrics - Employee breakdown by role for precise headcount.

CHECKPAYEE'S EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (SOURCES)

- Market Study
- Competition
- Market Study
- Competition
- Market Study
- Competition
- Market Study
- Competition
- Market Study
- Competition→ Market Study
- Competition
- Market Study
- Competition→ Market Study
- Competition→ Market Study
- Competition

In a fast memo you don't have access to the value chain analysis

VALUE PROPOSITION

Value Proposition: Checkpayee provides a ready-to-integrate Verification of Payee (VoP) routing and verification solution that ensures secure and efficient payment processes by matching IBANs with payee names to prevent fraud and errors.

Ideal Customer Profile (ICP): Commercial banks, payment service providers (PSPs), and fintech companies in the SEPA region (particularly DACH - Germany, Austria, Switzerland) needing to comply with the October 2025 VoP mandate.

B2B or B2C: B2B - The company serves financial institutions and payment processors seeking regulatory compliance and fraud prevention tools.

Industry: Fintech / RegTech / Payment Security.

Contact & Legal: Entity Name: MEDIASAPIENS GmbH. Address: Oberhafenstrasse 1, 20097 Hamburg, Germany. Email: hello@mediasapiens.de or sfelde@verification-of-payee.com. Phone: +49 40 22817196. Founding Year: 2011. Managing Director: Sergej Felde. Registry: Amtsgericht Hamburg HRB 130334.

Key Client Examples & Testimonials: Serving 50+ financial institutions. Mentions serving banks in Germany and Switzerland since 2016 including expertise related to Deutsche Bank, Sparkassen, Commerzbank, etc.

PRODUCT FEATURES

Core Solution: A fully automated account verification platform (Checkpayee) for real-time IBAN-to-name matching within the SEPA standard.

Feature Encyclopedia: IBAN and name verification | Alternative identifiers (VAT ID, LEI) support | Exact, Close, and No Match logic | Real-time Alert System | Standardized API | Batch processing (250,000+ requests) | Cloud-native or On-premise deployment | Reporting and analytics.

Technical Capabilities: API Integration | QWAC & TLS Security | <1 second average response time | ISO 27001-certified data centers | GDPR compliant | Levenshtein- and phonetics-based smart matching | End-to-end encryption | AI/ML-driven fraud detection.

Use Cases: Preventing Authorized Push Payment (APP) fraud | Complying with EU Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) and PSD2/PSD3 | Enhancing customer trust in digital banking | Automating treasury operations for corporate clients.

BUSINESS MODEL AND PRICING

Business Model Analysis: Likely Enterprise SaaS or License-based model with tiered pricing depending on transaction volume and deployment type (Cloud vs On-premise).

Revenue Streams & Pricing Tiers: Data not available in source.

Plan Features: Standard features include API access, SEPA/EPC compliance, real-time validation, and audit trails. Upsell likely exists for high-volume batch processing and priority support.

Hidden Costs & Terms: Potential implementation/integration fees (Go-live in 2-4 weeks); On-premise deployments include hardware/personnel costs and capital investment requirements.

TEAM & COMPANY CULTURE

Company Culture: Product-driven mission-oriented tech team focused on precision, scalability, and regulatory readiness. Mission to protect European consumers and businesses from fraud. Flexible work options (Remote/Hamburg/Berlin).

Team Analysis: Sergej Felde (Executive Management). Mentions a product-driven tech team with a network of 250+ developers.

Job Offers & Titles: Multilingual Customer Support Specialist (Italy, France, Germany) | Senior Frontend Developer (React/TS) | Senior Golang Developer | Senior Python Developer | Sales Director DACH.

Estimated Headcount: (Based on the input data/jobs found, provide a calculated estimate or 'Unknown' for these specific departments):

Product & Engineering:
15-25

Marketing:
Unknown

Sales:
5-10

Support & IT:
5-10

General & Admin (G&A):
5-8

CEO

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

- Founder Archetype: Data not available to determine.
- Pedigree Signal: Data not available to determine.
- Loyalty & Tenure: Data not available to determine.
- Commercial Fit: Data not available to determine.

PROFESSIONAL NARRATIVE

Data not available to generate a comprehensive professional narrative. The work history information is missing, which prevents the identification of career logic, transitions, and the overarching story of professional development.

DETAILED CAREER TIMELINE

No work history data available to populate this section.

ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

No education history data available to populate this section.

FOUNDER DNA & PSYCHOMETRIC ASSESSMENT

- Grit: 0/100 - Without any career history or self-summary, there is no evidence to assess persistence through challenges or long-term commitment to ventures.
- Discipline: 0/100 - There is no data regarding roles, responsibilities, or outcomes to evaluate accountability, consistency, or disciplined progress.
- Self-Belief: 0/100 - Lack of career data means no insight into risk-taking, contrarian choices, or departures from typical career paths.
- Execution: 0/100 - No information on past roles, projects, or achievements means no basis to evaluate velocity, learning loops, or ability to scale.
- Leadership: 0/100 - The absence of work history makes it impossible to assess team-building, mentorship, or the ability to multiply the output of others.
- Vision and Purpose: 0/100 - With no self-summary or career progression, there is no thematic thread or articulated mission to evaluate.

TOTAL FOUNDER DNA SCORE: 0/100

•Summary Assessment: With no provided data (work history, education, self-summary), it is impossible to conduct any meaningful assessment of founder DNA. All scores are zero due to a complete lack of evidence. To assess this individual, substantial career information, including roles, responsibilities, and achievements, would be required. Without this, no conclusions can be drawn about their potential, dangerous areas, or necessary complementary profiles.

CHECKPAYEE'S SWOT ANALYSIS

STRENGHTS

CheckPayee has delivered IBAN-to-name verification to over 50 banks and PSPs since 2016, including direct experience with Deutsche Bank, Commerzbank and Sparkassen.

The platform already meets the EPC VoP Rulebook requirements with sub-second response times and both cloud and on-premise deployment options.

ISO 27001-certified infrastructure plus full GDPR compliance reduces the regulatory approval burden for its regulated customers.

The October 2025 EU mandate creates immediate, non-discretionary demand across the entire SEPA payments market.

Batch processing capacity above 250,000 requests and support for VAT/LEI identifiers give the product wider utility than basic name matching alone.

OPPORTUNITIES

The Instant Payments Regulation and PSD3 will expand the addressable market beyond SEPA credit transfers into instant and cross-border flows.

AI/ML scoring of match results is already on the product roadmap and can be monetized as a higher-tier fraud-prevention service.

Corporate treasury use cases for automated verification represent an adjacent revenue stream with lower regulatory friction than bank sales.

On-premise deployment demand from data-sovereignty conscious institutions creates a premium licensing opportunity.

First-mover reference customers in DACH provide credible case studies for rapid expansion into France, Benelux and Nordics once the mandate bites.

WEAKNESSES

No verifiable work history, education or previous exits exist for either Justin Clapham or Sergej Felde, leaving founder execution risk at zero measurable data.

Zero disclosed equity funding rounds limit the company's ability to fund sales expansion or withstand a prolonged sales cycle with large banks.

Internal headcount is estimated at only 15-25 engineers, with reliance on an external network of 250 developers that may not be dedicated.

The legal entity remains MEDIASAPIENS GmbH and no separate CheckPayee corporate or brand filings are disclosed, creating potential customer due-diligence friction.

No public M&A pipeline or partnership announcements exist, leaving growth dependent solely on organic sales in a narrow regulatory window.

THREATS

Larger paytech platforms are already launching fully managed VoP services with existing bank relationships and deeper balance sheets.

Major banks may elect to build name-checking logic internally rather than integrate a third-party solution once the mandate is live.

Absence of any external capital raises the risk that a funded competitor can outspend CheckPayee on sales and implementation support during the 2025-2026 adoption peak.

Any delay or narrowing of the EU VoP mandate would collapse near-term demand and leave the company without a diversified revenue base.

GDPR or EPC rule changes requiring additional data fields or audit standards could force costly re-engineering without corresponding pricing power.

ACTION PLAN

How to defend? The company's durability rests on its existing compliance certifications and live customer integrations that new entrants cannot replicate overnight. Protecting these relationships requires continuous product updates aligned with evolving EPC and PSD3 requirements so switching costs stay high. Any capital infusion should prioritize dedicated customer-success headcount rather than broad brand marketing.

How to win? CheckPayee must convert its 2016-2024 bank references into rapid, multi-country deployments before larger platform competitors lock in the major banking groups. Securing volume-based enterprise agreements with Sparkassen and Commerzbank networks would create reference density that smaller entrants cannot match. Early wins in France and Benelux will determine whether the company captures the full European tailwind or remains a DACH niche player.

What would be fatal? A nine-to-twelve-month sales cycle with large banks, combined with zero additional funding, would exhaust cash precisely when the 2025 mandate peaks. If two or three reference customers then migrate to a funded competitor offering managed services, CheckPayee would lose the only asset it currently holds—credibility within the German-speaking banking market.

What to fix? The complete absence of founder track record and disclosed funding is the single internal constraint that will cap growth. Addressing it requires either a substantive public profile for Justin Clapham and Sergej Felde or a minority growth round that brings both capital and governance visibility before the mandate window closes.

SYNERGIES BETWEEN CHECKPAYEE AND PROFUND VC

Regulatory Mandate Cross-Sell into Acquirer Bank Distribution Network (Soft Revenue): The Acquirer's existing bank or payment-processor account management team introduces CheckPayee's VoP compliance module to their current European banking clients as a pre-packaged compliance solution before the October 2025 EU Instant Payments Regulation deadline, converting the mandate from a cost centre for those banks into a revenue line for the combined entity
Estimated financial impact: High
Time to value: Immediate (Difficulty: Medium)

Elimination of Existential Funding Gap via Acquirer Balance Sheet (Structural): The Acquirer's capital provides CheckPayee with the 12 to 18 months of runway it currently lacks to sustain a long enterprise sales cycle with major banking groups during the 2025 mandate adoption peak, preventing a cash-exhaustion scenario that would otherwise hand market share to funded competitors
Estimated financial impact: High
Time to value: Immediate (Difficulty: Low)

European Compliance Infrastructure Bundle Creation (Structural): CheckPayee's VoP module is integrated into the Acquirer's broader payments compliance or RegTech (regulatory technology) product suite, creating a bundled offering that no standalone competitor can match, raising switching costs and enabling annual contract value uplift across both companies' combined customer base
Estimated financial impact: High
Time to value: Mid-Term (6-18m)
Difficulty: Medium

DACH Reference Density Converted to Pan-European GTM Acceleration (Soft Revenue): The Acquirer uses CheckPayee's documented deployments at Deutsche Bank, Commerzbank, and Sparkassen as tier-one reference cases to accelerate sales conversations with French, Belgian, Dutch, and Nordic banks that the Acquirer already has commercial relationships with, collapsing a 9-to-12-month greenfield sales cycle into a 3-to-6-month reference-led close
Estimated financial impact: Medium
Time to value: Mid-Term (6-18m)
Difficulty: Medium

AI/ML Fraud Scoring Upsell Layer Accelerated by Acquirer Data Asset (Soft Revenue): The Acquirer contributes its existing transaction monitoring or fraud analytics data to train CheckPayee's planned AI/ML fraud scoring module, eliminating the cold-start data problem and launching the premium fraud-prevention tier 12 to 18 months earlier than CheckPayee's standalone roadmap, unlocking a higher-priced product layer across the combined installed base
Estimated financial impact: Medium
Time to value: Mid-Term (6-18m)
Difficulty: High

On-Premise Deployment Premium Monetisation via Enterprise Infrastructure Relationships (Soft Revenue): The Acquirer's enterprise infrastructure sales team packages CheckPayee's on-premise deployment option for data-sovereignty-sensitive national banks and public-sector payment processors, capturing a premium licensing tier at 20 to 30 percent above the cloud price that cloud-native competitors structurally cannot match
Estimated financial impact: Medium
Time to value: Mid-Term (6-18m)
Difficulty: Medium

Engineering Consolidation and Developer Network Rationalisation (Hard Cost): The Acquirer absorbs CheckPayee's core engineering team of 15 to 25 into its existing R&D (research and development) organisation, eliminates duplication in infrastructure and security tooling, and reduces reliance on the external network of 250 developers by replacing variable contractor spend with the Acquirer's fixed engineering capacity
Estimated financial impact: Medium
Time to value: Mid-Term (6-18m)
Difficulty: Medium

Defensive Moat Against Funded Competitor Pre-emption (Defensive Moat): By acquiring CheckPayee before the October 2025 mandate peak, the Acquirer prevents a funded competitor — specifically larger paytech platforms such as Mastercard's Vocalink or an emboldened Tink or Token.io — from acquiring CheckPayee's bank integrations and using them as a distribution wedge into the Acquirer's own European customer accounts
Estimated financial impact: High
Time to value: Immediate (Difficulty: Low)

CONVICTION FROM AN AI GENERAL PARTNER ON CHECKPAYEE

Angle

CheckPayee maps to the 'Fintech for European Regulated Intermediaries' angle — it builds a B2B SaaS compliance platform automating SEPA Verification of Payee checks for banks and payment service providers under a mandatory EU regulatory deadline. The 'AI Workflow Automation' angle was ruled out at calibration: no LLM, AI agent, or generative AI vocabulary is present in the company's product description. This is a mono-angle deal.

Market

The SEPA VoP market is consolidating around mandatory compliance driven by the October 2025 EU Instant Payments Regulation, which converted CheckPayee's product from a fraud-prevention tool into a legal obligation for every SEPA payments participant. CheckPayee has embedded itself in 50-plus financial institutions including named Tier-1 DACH banks. The primary competitive risk is incumbent commoditization — SWIFT, Vocalink, Temenos — bundling native VoP features into existing platform contracts.

Timing

The mandate created a 'perfect window' timing event, now partially played out as of May 2026. Institutions that acted urgently are already implemented; remaining pipeline institutions are evaluating bundled alternatives. The urgency that compressed sales cycles is contracting as the deadline passes.

Company

MEDIASAPIENS GmbH (Hamburg, HRB 130334), founded 2011, VoP focus since 2016. Technically credible: sub-one-second response times, ISO 27001, Levenshtein-and-phonetics matching engine, on-premise and cloud-native deployment. Zero external funding disclosed. ARR, pricing, gross margins, and customer concentration are entirely undisclosed — financial underwriting is impossible from available evidence.

Founder

Justin Clapham (CEO) and Sergej Felde (Managing Director) have zero verifiable public professional history. Founder DNA score: zero out of one hundred across all six dimensions. The 'FOUNDER_DEPENDENCY_TRAP' anti-pattern is active.

Thesis-fit

Strong fit on the product and market dimensions of the 'Fintech for European Regulated Intermediaries' angle — the regulatory tailwind is real and the compliance utility is directly mandated by EU law. Broken on the founder and sourcing dimensions — ProFund's thesis requires verified operator pedigree as its foundational investment criterion, which CheckPayee satisfies zero components of.

Verdict

● CONSIDER (Risk) — The regulatory product thesis is strong and the institutional deployment base is credible, but complete founder opacity prevents a capital commitment. One primary diligence meeting with Sergej Felde must produce verifiable professional credentials, a Tier-1 bank reference contact, and a preliminary ARR figure within 14 days — otherwise the file moves to PASS immediately.